

at tips and 4in (10cm) long, in summer on fully mature plants. Z10–11 (min. 41°F/5°C)

ORIGANUM

Marjoram, Oregano

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of deciduous and evergreen subshrubs and herbaceous perennials, sometimes with overwintering leaf rosettes. Some species are grown as culinary herbs, others for their clusters of tubular, usually pink flowers. Most species have arching, prostrate stems and are useful for trailing over rocks, banks, and walls. Fully to frost hardy. Prefers sun and well-drained, alkaline soil. Propagate by division in spring, by cuttings of non-flowering shoots in early summer, or by seed in fall or spring.

O. amanum. Deciduous, rounded, compact subshrub. H and S 6–8in (15–20cm). Open funnel-shaped, pale pink or white flowers are borne all summer above small, heart-shaped, pale green leaves. A good alpine house plant; dislikes a damp atmosphere. Z5–9

O. dictamnus (Cretan dittany). Prostrate perennial. H 5–6in (12–15cm), S 40cm (16in). Arching stems are clothed in rounded, aromatic, hairy, gray-white leaves. Produces pendent heads of open funnel-shaped, purplish-pink flowers in summer. Z9–11

O. ‘Kent Beauty’ illus. p.339.

O. laevigatum illus. p.340.

O. rotundifolium. Deciduous, prostrate subshrub. H 9–12in (23–30cm), S 1ft (30cm). Throughout summer bears whorls of pendent, funnel-shaped, pale pink flowers, surrounded by yellow-green bracts. Has small, rounded, mid-green leaves. Z5–9

O. vulgare (Wild marjoram). Mat-forming, woody-based perennial. H and S 1½ft (45cm). Has ovate, aromatic, dark green leaves, above which branched, wiry stems bear clusters of tiny, 2-lipped, tubular, mauve flowers in summer. Z4–10. ‘**Aureum**’ illus. p.274. ‘**Compactum**, H to 6in (15cm), S to 1ft (30cm), is dense, compact, and dome-forming, with smaller leaves, to ¾in (2cm) long.

ORNITHOGALUM

Star-of-Bethlehem

HYACINTHACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of bulbs, grown for their mostly star-shaped, white flowers, usually backed with green. Fully hardy to frost tender. Needs sun or partial shade and well-drained soil. Smaller species are suitable for a rock garden; taller ones for a herbaceous border. Lift and dry tender species for winter, if grown outside in summer, and replant in spring. Propagate by seed or offsets, in fall for spring-flowering plants, in spring for summer-flowering ones. ☹Handle carefully as all parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested; the sap may irritate skin.

O. arabicum illus. p.409.

O. balansae, syn. *O. oligophyllum* of gardens, illus. p.414.

O. lanceolatum illus. p.415.

O. magnum illus. p.382.

O. montanum illus. p.415.

O. narbonense illus. p.408.

O. nutans illus. p.399.

O. oligophyllum of gardens. See *O. balansae*.

O. saundersiae. Summer-flowering bulb. H to 3ft (1m), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Produces a basal cluster of strap- or lance-shaped, semierect, dark green, sometimes grayish-green leaves. Stem bears a flat-topped head of erect, cup-shaped, white or cream flowers, each with a blackish-green ovary forming a dark eye. Z10–11

O. thyrsoides (Chincherinchee) illus. p.408.

O. umbellatum illus. p.416.

Orobus vernus. See *Lathyrus vernus*.

ORONTIUM

Golden club

ARACEAE

Genus of one species of deciduous, perennial, deep-water plant, grown for its floating foliage and flower spikes. Fully hardy. Needs full sun. Remove faded flower spikes. Propagate by sowing seed, as soon as ripe, in midsummer. Divide rhizomes in spring.

O. aquaticum (Golden club) illus. p.444.

OROSTACHYS

CRASSULACEAE

Genus of short-lived, basal-rosetted, perennial succulents with very fleshy, sword-shaped leaves. Produces flowers 3 years from sowing seed, then dies. Fully hardy to frost tender. Requires sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or division in spring or summer.

O. spinosus. Clump-forming, perennial succulent. H to 8in (20cm), S 4in (10cm). Produces compact rosettes of narrowly oblong, spine-tipped, gray-green leaves, to 1¼in (3cm) long. Dense, cylindrical racemes, to 8in (20cm) long, of star-shaped, yellow to white flowers, ½–¾in (1–2cm) across, with protruding yellow stamens, are borne in summer. Z6–9

OROYA

CACTACEAE

Genus of spherical, perennial cacti with flowers borne in summer. Inner flower petals form a tube and outer ones open fully. Frost tender. Needs a sunny, well-drained site. Propagate by seed in spring or summer.

O. neoperuviana. See *O. peruviana*.

O. peruviana, syn. *O. neoperuviana*, illus. p.486.

Orphanidesia. See *Epigaea*.

ORTHROSANTHUS

IRIDACEAE

Genus of perennials with short, woody rhizomes, grown for their blue flowers, borne on slender, erect stalks. Flowers are short-lived, but open in succession for 2 weeks or more from late spring to summer. Frost hardy to frost tender. Prefers sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by division or seed in spring.

O. chimboracensis. Tufted, rhizomatous perennial. H 2ft (60cm) in flower, S 6in (15cm). Has very narrow, grasslike, ribbed, stiff leaves, to 1½ft (45cm) long, with finely toothed margins. In summer, bears clusters of short-lived, long-stalked, shallowly bowl-shaped, lavender-blue flowers, each enclosed in 2 leaflike bracts. Z9–11

ORYCHOPHRAGMUS

BRASSICACEAE/CRUCIFERAE

Genus of late spring- to summer-flowering annuals, grown for their cross-shaped flowers with 4-clawed, violet petals. Half hardy. Grow in sun and in fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring.

O. violaceus. Moderately fast-growing, upright annual or biennial. H 1–2ft (30–60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has branching stems with thin, finely divided, pale green, basal leaves and smaller, pointed-ovate, pale green, stem-clasping leaves. Bears heads of 4-petaled, purple-blue flowers in late spring and early summer. Z10–11

OSBECKIA

MELASTOMATACEAE

Genus of evergreen, summer-flowering perennials, subshrubs and shrubs, grown for their flowers and foliage. Frost tender. Needs full light or partial shade and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water potted plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Cut back flowered stems by at least half in early spring to maintain vigor and to produce large flower trusses. Propagate by seed in spring or by greenwood cuttings in summer.

O. stellata. Evergreen, rounded, stiff-stemmed shrub. H and S 3–6ft (1–2m). Has narrowly ovate, hairy, prominently veined leaves. Produces terminal clusters of 4-petaled, rose-purple flowers in late summer. Z11–12 (min. 55°F/13°C)

OSCULARIA

AIZOCEAE

Genus of spreading, sometimes erect, subshrubby perennial succulents with daisylike, white to pink flowers, and usually angular, fleshy, grayish-green leaves. Frost hardy to frost tender. Use for summer bedding or as potted plants. With age becomes woody. Requires full sun and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or fall.

O. deltoides, syn. *Lampranthus deltoides*, illus. p.485.

OSMANTHUS

OLEACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their foliage and small, usually fragrant flowers. *O. x burkwoodii*, *O. delavayi*, and *O. heterophyllum* may be used for hedging. Fully hardy to frost tender. Tolerates sun or shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Restrict growth by cutting back after flowering; trim hedges in midsummer. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

O. armatus. Evergreen, bushy, dense shrub. H and S 12ft (4m). Large, oblong, dark green leaves are rigid and sharply

toothed. Produces tubular, 4-lobed, white flowers in fall, followed by egg-shaped, dark violet fruits. Z8–10

O. x burkwoodii, syn. *x Osmarea burkwoodii*, illus. p.110.

O. decorus, syn. *Phillyrea decora*. Evergreen, upright, rounded, dense shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 15ft (5m). Has large, oblong, glossy, dark green leaves. Bears tubular, 4-lobed, white flowers in late spring, then egg-shaped, blackish-purple fruits. Z6–8

O. delavayi, syn. *Siphonosmanthus delavayi*, illus. p.110.

O. forrestii. See *O. yunnanensis*.

O. fragrans (Fragrant olive). Evergreen, upright shrub or tree. H and S 20ft (6m). Very fragrant, tubular, 4-lobed, white flowers are borne amid oblong, glossy, dark green leaves early to late summer, followed by ovoid, blue-black fruits. Suitable only for very mild areas. Z9–11.

f. aurantiacus has orange flowers.

O. heterophyllum. Evergreen dense, mounded shrub. H and S 15ft (5m). Has hollylike, sharply toothed, glossy, dark green leaves, often spineless on mature plants. Produces small clusters of fragrant, tubular, 4-lobed, white flowers from late summer to fall, followed by ovoid, blue-black fruit. Z7–9.

‘**Argenteomarginatus**’ see. *O.h. ‘Variegatus’*. ‘**Aureomarginatus**’ illus. p.119. ‘**Goshiki**’, H and S 6ft (2m), has pinkish bronze leaves when young, changing to creamy yellow marbled with gray-green, finally turning dark green flecked with cream and gray. ‘**Gulftide**’, H 8ft (2.5m), S 10ft (3m), is compact, with very spiny leaves. ‘**Variegatus**’ (syn. *O.h. ‘Argenteomarginatus*’), H and S 8ft (2.5m), is compact, with gray-green leaves, margined creamy white.

O. yunnanensis, syn. *O. forrestii*. Evergreen, treelike, upright, then spreading shrub. H and S 30ft (10m). Has large, oblong, glossy, bright green leaves, bronze when young. Produces tubular, 4-lobed, creamy-white flowers in clusters in late winter or early spring. Z8–10

x *Osmarea burkwoodii*. See *Osmanthus x burkwoodii*.

Osmaronia. See *Oemleria*.

OSMUNDA

OSMUNDACEAE

Genus of deciduous ferns. Fully hardy to frost hardy. Requires shade, except for *O. regalis*, which also tolerates sun. *O. cinnamomea* and *O. claytoniana* need moist soil; *O. regalis* does best in very wet conditions. Remove fading fronds regularly. Propagate by division in fall or winter, or by spores as soon as ripe.

O. cinnamomea (Cinnamon fern). Deciduous fern. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Outer, lance-shaped, divided, pale green sterile fronds, with deeply cut pinnae, surround brown fertile fronds, all arising from a fibrous rootstock. Z3–9

O. claytoniana (Interrupted fern). Deciduous fern. H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has lance-shaped, pale green fronds, divided into oblong, blunt pinnae; outer sterile fronds are larger than fertile ones at center of plant. Z3–9

O. regalis (Royal fern) illus. p.443.